

Data Structures and Algorithms

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Lecture #4

- Stacks
- Queues

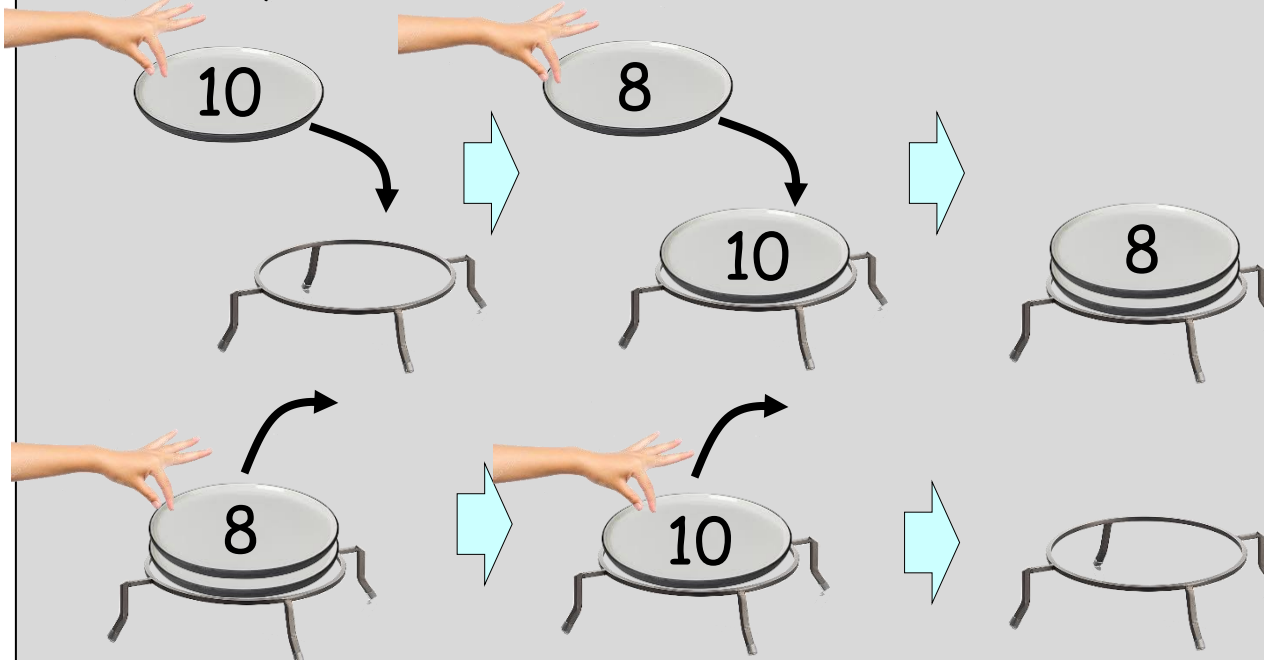


Stacks

What's the big picture?

A stack is a data structure that resembles a stack of plates at a buffet.

Just like a stack of plates, the last plate/value you add is at the top of the stack, and thus the first to be removed.



The last-added/first-removed aspect of stacks can help solve many hard problems!

Uses:

Use stacks to find a path through a maze, "undo" in a word processor, and evaluate math expressions.

The Stack: A Useful ADT

A stack is an ADT that holds a collection of items (like **ints**) where the elements are always added to one end.

Just like a stack of plates, the last item pushed onto the top of a stack is the first item to be removed.

Stack operations:

- put something on top of the stack (**PUSH**)
- remove the top item (**POP**)
- look at the top item, without removing it
- check to see if the stack is empty

We can have a stack of any type of variable we like:
ints, Squares, floats, strings, etc.

The Stack

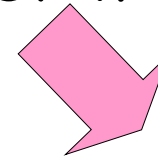
Note: The stack is called a **Last-In-First-Out** data structure.

Can you figure out why?

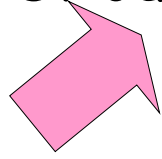
I can...

Push 5 on the stack.
Push -3 on the stack.
Push 9 on the stack.
Pop the top of the stack.
Look at the stack's top value.
Push 4 on the stack.
Pop the top of the stack
Pop the top of the stack
Look at the stack's top value.
Pop the top of the stack

last in



first out



-3
5



Note: You can only access the top item of the stack, since the other items are covered.

Stacks

```
class Stack // stack of ints
{
public:
    Stack();    // c'tor
    void push(int i);
    int pop();
    bool is_empty(void);
    int peek_top();
private:
    ...
};
```

Question:

What type of data structure can we use to implement our stack?

```
int main(void)
{
    Stack is;

    is.push(10);
    is.push(20);

    ...
}
```

Answer:

How about an array and a counter variable to track where the top of the stack is?

Implementer

```
const int SIZE = 100;
```

```
class Stack
```

```
{
```

```
public:
```

```
Stack() { m_top = 0;
```

```
void push(int val)
```

```
    if (m_top >= SIZE)
```

```
        m_stack[m_top] = val;
```

```
    m_top += 1;
```

```
}
```

```
int pop()
```

```
    if (m_top == 0) exit(1);
```

```
    m_top -= 1;
```

```
    return m_stack[m_top];
```

```
}
```

```
...
```

```
private:
```

```
int m_stack[SIZE];
```

```
int m_top;
```

```
};
```

To initialize our stack,

Update the location where
our **next item** should be

Since **m_top** points to where our

Extract the value from the top
of the stack and return it to
the user.

We'll use a simple **int** to
keep track of where the
next item **should be**
added to the stack.

Let's use

This **stack**
maximum

Stacks

The first item we push
will be placed in

Currently, our `m_top` points to the
next open slot in the stack...

But we want to return the top item
already pushed on the stack.

So first we must decrement our
`m_top` variable...

```
const int SIZE =
```

```
class Stack
```

```
{
public:
```

```
→ Stack
```

```
→ void
```

```
→ is
```

```
→ m
```

```
→ m
```

```
}
```

```
→ int pop
```

```
→ if
```

```
→ m_top
```

```
→ return m_stack[m_top];
```

```
}
```

```
...
```

```
private:
```

```
int m_stack[SIZE];
```

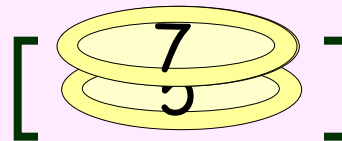
```
int m_top;
```

```
};
```

re `m_stack[1]`

so we return 10

/ underflow



```
int main(void)
{
```

```
→ Stack is;
```

```
→ int a;
```

```
→ is.push(5);
```

```
→ is.push(10);
```

```
→ a = is.pop();
```

```
→ cout << a;
```

```
→ is.push(7);
```

```
}
```

is

`m_top` 2

`m_stack`

0	5
1	7
2	
...	...
99	

...

a 10


```

const int SIZE = 100;
class Stack
{
public:
    Stack() { m_top = 0; }
    void push(int val) {
        if (m_top >= SIZE) exit(-1); // overflow
        m_stack[m_top] = val;
        m_top += 1;
    }

    int pop() {
        if (m_top == 0) exit(-1); // underflow
        m_top -= 1;
        return m_stack[m_top];
    }

    ...
private:
    int m_stack[SIZE];
    int m_top;
};

```

Always Remember:

When we **push**, we:

- A. Store the new item in **m_stack[m_top]**
- B. **Post-increment** our **m_top** variable
(post means we do the increment after storing)

Always Remember:

When we **pop**, we:

- A. **Pre-decrement** our **m_top** variable
- B. Return the item in **m_stack[m_top]**
(pre means we do the decrement before returning)

Stacks are
one for you

Here's the

`std::st`

And as with `cin` and `cout`, you can remove the `std::` prefix if you add a `using namespace std;` command!

Example:

```
#include <iostream>
#include <stack>
using namespace std;
std::stack<string> stackOfStrings;
std::stack<double> stackOfDoubles;

int main()
{
```

```
    stack<int> istack; // stack of ints
```

```
    istack.push(10);
    istack.push(20);
```

```
    cout << istack.top(); // prints 20
    istack.pop();
```

```
    if (istack.empty() == false)
        cout << istack.size();
```

```
}
```

So to get the top item's value, before popping it, use the `top()` method!

Note: The STL `pop()` command simply throws away the top item from the stack... but it **doesn't return it**.

Stack Challenge

Show the resulting stack after the following program runs:

```
#include <iostream>
#include <stack>
using namespace std;

int main()
{
    stack<int> istack;           // stack of ints

    istack.push(6);
    for (int i=0;i<2;i++)
    {
        int n = istack.top();
        istack.pop();
        istack.push(i);
        istack.push(n*2);
    }
}
```

Stack Challenge

Show the resulting stack after the following program runs:

```
#include <iostream>
#include <stack>
using namespace std;

int main()
{
→ stack<int> istack;           // stack of ints

→ istack.push(6);
→ for (int i=0;i<2;i++)
{
→ int n = istack.top();
→ istack.pop();
→ istack.push(i);
→ istack.push(n*2);
}
→ }
```

A Stack... in your CPU!

Did you know that every CPU has a built-in stack used to hold **local variables** and **function return values**?



When you **pass a value to a function**, the CPU **pushes** that value onto a **stack** in the computer's memory.

function,
stack

Local variables are stored on the computer's built-in stack!

returns, the values **pop** off the **stack** and go away.

you **declare a local variable**, your program **pushes** it on the PC's **stack** automatically!

b	10
a	5
x	5

```
void bar(int b)
{
    cout << b << endl;
}
```

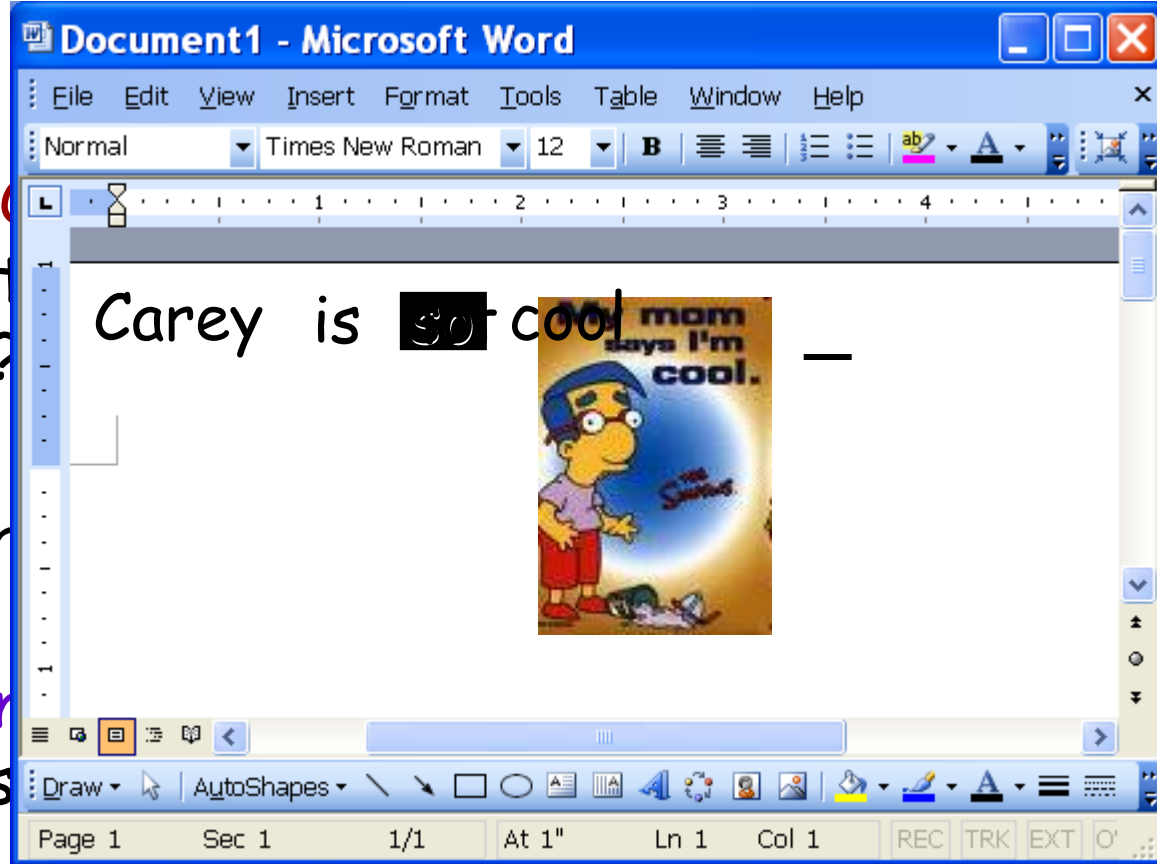
```
void foo(int a)
{
    cout << a << endl;
    bar(10);
}
```

```
int main(void)
{
    int x = 5;
    foo(5);
}
```

When the user hits the
 So how does the **UNDO**
 feature of your favorite
 word processor work?

The word processor
 pops the top item off
 the stack and removes
 it from the document!

Every time you type a
 word, it's added to the stack



Every time you cut-and-paste
 an image into your doc, it's
 added to the stack!
 The word processor can track the last X
 things that you did and
 And even when you delete
 text or pictures, this is
 tracked on a stack!



"so" → "not"

"cool"

"so"

"is"

"Carey"

undo stack

Postfix Expression Evaluation

Most people are used to **infix notation**, where the operator is **in-between**

Postfix notation is **operator after operand** - here the **operator**

As we'll see, postfix expressions have no such ambiguity!

Infix	Postfix
$15 + 6 * 3$	$15\ 6\ +\ 3\ *$

If you've ever used an HP calculator, you've used postfix notation!

Is that $(5+10) * 3$
or
 $5 + (10 * 3)$

To understand infix expressions, the computer has to be equipped with precedence rules!

is ambiguous, because they're **unambiguous**

infix expression example: $5 + 10 * 3$



Postfix Evaluation Algorithm

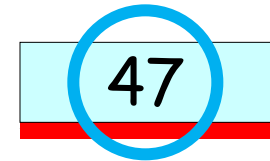
Inputs: postfix expression string

Output: number representing answer

Private data: a stack

7 6 * 5 +

- 1. Start with the left-most token.
- 2. If the token is a **number**:
 - a. Push it onto the stack
- 3. Else if the token is an **operator**:
 - a. ~~Pop the top value into a variable called v2, and the second-to-top value into v1.~~
... // we'll see this in a bit!
 - b. Apply operator to v1 and v2 (e.g., v1 / v2)
 - c. Push the result of the operation on the stack
- 4. If there are more tokens, advance to the next token and go back to step #2
- 5. After all tokens have been processed, the top # on the stack is the answer!



Infix to Postfix Conversion

Stacks can also be used to convert
infix expression to postfix expression

For example,

From: $(3 + 5) * (4 + 3 / 2)$

To: $3\ 5\ +\ 4\ 3\ 2\ /\ +\ *\ 5\ -$

Or

From: $3 + 6 * 7 * 8 - 3$

To: $3\ 6\ 7\ *\ 8\ *\ +\ 3\ -$

Since people are more used to infix notation...

You can let the user type in an infix expression...

And then convert it into a postfix expression.

Finally, you can use the postfix evaluation alg
(that we just learned)
to compute the value of the expression.

A 7x7 grid representing a maze. The columns are indexed 0 to 7 from left to right, and the rows are indexed 0 to 7 from top to bottom. The start point is at (1,1) and the finish point is at (6,6). The path is highlighted in light blue.

	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
0								
1								
2								
3								
4								
5								
6								
7								

Solving a Maze with a Stack!

Inputs: 10x10 Maze in a 2D array,
Starting point (sx,sy)
Ending point (ex,ey)

Output: TRUE if the maze can be solved, FALSE otherwise

Private data: a stack of *points*

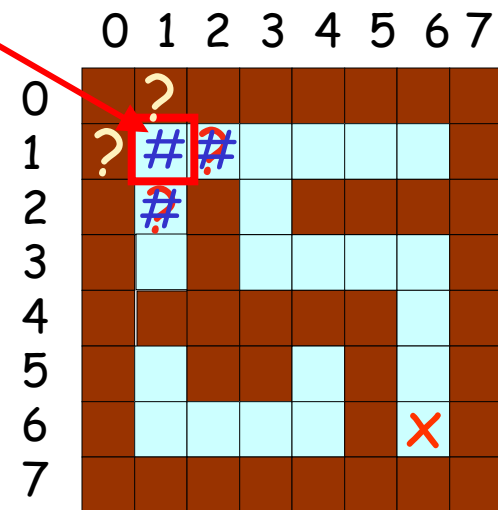
```
class Point
{
public:
    Point(int x, int y);
    int getx() const;
    int gety() const;
private:
    int m_x, m_y;
};
```

```
class Stack
{
public:
    Stack();    // c'tor
    void push(Point &p);
    Point pop();
    ...
private:
    ...
};
```

Solving a Maze with a Stack!

- 1. PUSH **starting point** onto the stack.
- 2. Mark the **starting point** as "discovered."
- 3. While the stack is not empty:
 - A. Use the stack pointer for the stack as a variable.
 - B. If we're at the end point, DONE! Otherwise...
 - C. If slot to the **WEST** is open & is undiscovered
Mark (curx-1,cury) as "discovered"
PUSH (curx-1,cury) on stack.
 - D. If slot to the **EAST** is open & is undiscovered
 - Mark (curx+1,cury) as "discovered"
 - PUSH (curx+1,cury) on stack.
 - E. If slot to the **NORTH** is open & is undiscovered
Mark (curx,cury-1) as "discovered"
PUSH (curx,cury-1) on stack.
 - F. If slot to the **SOUTH** is open & is undiscovered
 - Mark (curx,cury+1) as "discovered"
 - PUSH (curx,cury+1) on stack.
- 4. If the stack is empty and we haven't reached our goal position, then the maze is unsolvable.

$sx, sy = 1, 1$



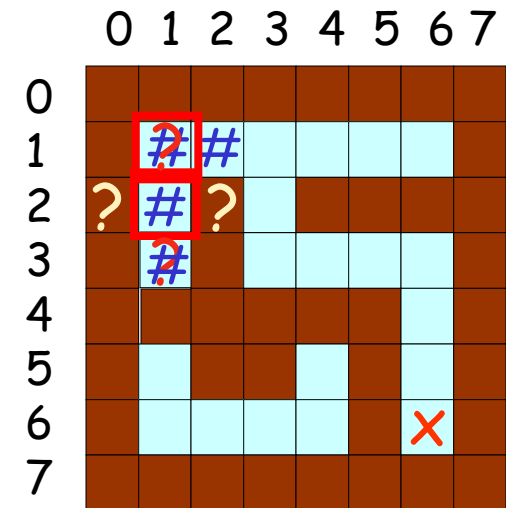
$1, 1 == 6, 6?$
Not yet!

cur = 1,1

1	2
2	1

Solving a Maze with a Stack!

1. PUSH **starting point** onto the stack.
2. Mark the **starting point** as "discovered."
- 3. While the stack is not empty:
 - A. POP the top point off the stack into a variable.
 - B. If we're at the endpoint, DONE! Otherwise...
 - C. If slot to the **WEST** is open & is undiscovered
Mark (curx-1,cury) as "discovered"
PUSH (curx-1,cury) on stack.
 - D. If slot to the **EAST** is open & is undiscovered
Mark (curx+1,cury) as "discovered"
PUSH (curx+1,cury) on stack.
 - E. If slot to the **NORTH** is open & is undiscovered
Mark (curx,cury-1) as "discovered"
PUSH (curx,cury-1) on stack.
 - F. If slot to the **SOUTH** is open & is undiscovered
 - Mark (curx,cury+1) as "discovered"
 - PUSH (curx,cury+1) on stack.
4. If the stack is empty and we haven't reached our goal position, then the maze is unsolvable.



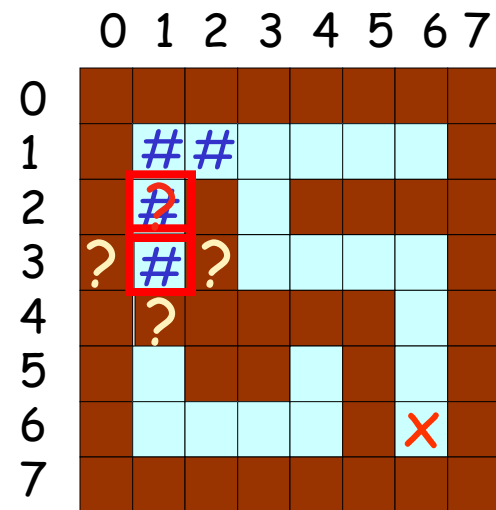
1,2 == 6,6?
Not yet!

cur = 1,2

1, 3
2, 1

Solving a Maze with a Stack!

1. PUSH **starting point** onto the stack.
2. Mark the **starting point** as "discovered."
- 3. While the stack is not empty:
 - A. POP the top point off the stack into a variable.
 - B. If we're at the endpoint, DONE! Otherwise...
 - C. If slot to the **WEST** is open & is undiscovered
Mark (curx-1,cury) as "discovered"
PUSH (curx-1,cury) on stack.
 - D. If slot to the **EAST** is open & is undiscovered
Mark (curx+1,cury) as "discovered"
PUSH (curx+1,cury) on stack.
 - E. If slot to the **NORTH** is open & is undiscovered
Mark (curx,cury-1) as "discovered"
PUSH (curx,cury-1) on stack.
 - F. If slot to the **SOUTH** is open & is undiscovered
Mark (curx,cury+1) as "discovered"
PUSH (curx,cury+1) on stack.
4. If the stack is empty and we haven't reached our goal position, then the maze is unsolvable.



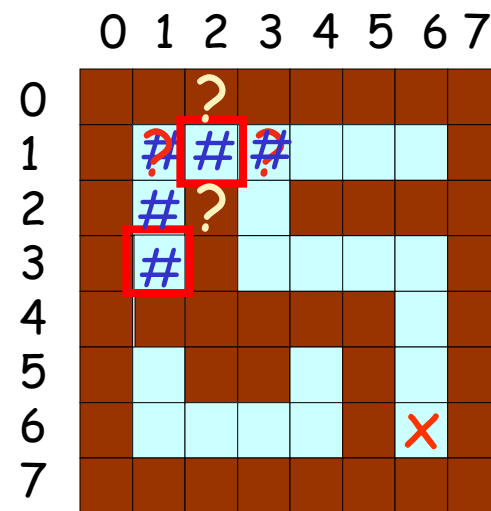
1,3 == 6,6?
Not yet!

cur = 1,3

1, 3
2, 1

Solving a Maze with a Stack!

1. PUSH **starting point** onto the stack.
2. Mark the **starting point** as "discovered."
- 3. While the stack is not empty:
 - A. POP the top point off the stack into a variable.
 - B. If we're at the endpoint, DONE! Otherwise...
 - C. If slot to the **WEST** is open & is undiscovered
Mark (curx-1,cury) as "discovered"
PUSH (curx-1,cury) on stack.
 - D. If slot to the **EAST** is open & is undiscovered
 - Mark (curx+1,cury) as "discovered"
 - PUSH (curx+1,cury) on stack.
 - E. If slot to the **NORTH** is open & is undiscovered
Mark (curx,cury-1) as "discovered"
PUSH (curx,cury-1) on stack.
 - F. If slot to the **SOUTH** is open & is undiscovered
Mark (curx,cury+1) as "discovered"
PUSH (curx,cury+1) on stack.
4. If the stack is empty and we haven't reached our goal position, then the maze is unsolvable.



2,1 == 6,6?
Not yet!

cur = 2,1

Solving a Maze with a Stack!

1. PUSH **starting point** onto the stack.
2. Mark the **starting point** as "discovered."
- 3. While the stack is not empty:
 - A. POP the top point off the stack into a variable.
 - B. If we're at the endpoint, DONE! Otherwise...
 - C. If slot to the **WEST** is open & is undiscovered
 Mark (curx-1, cury)
 PUSH (curx-1, cury)



Eventually, we'll find the solution to the maze, or our stack will empty out, indicating that there is no solution!

This searching algorithm is called a "depth-first search."

3,1 == 6,6?
Not yet!

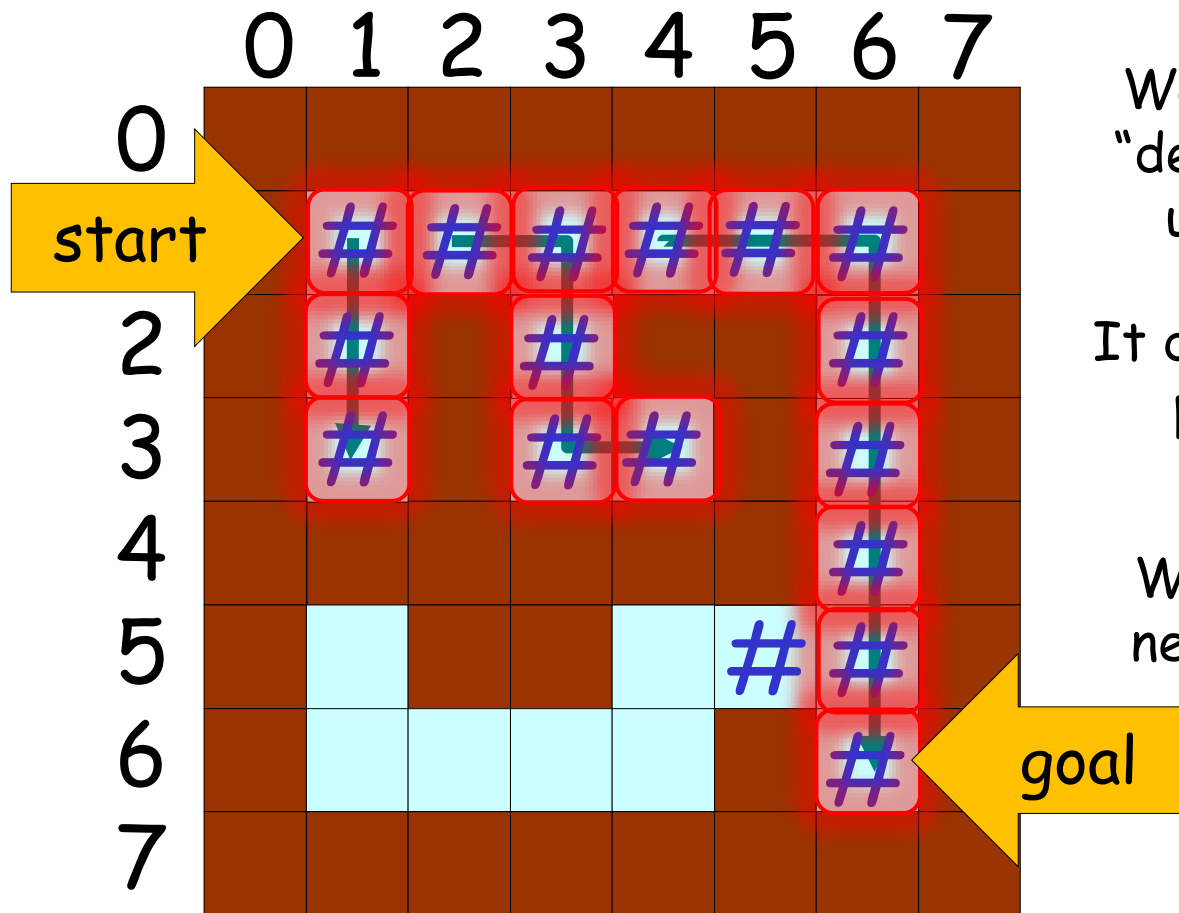
- D. If slot to the **EAST** is open & is undiscovered
 Mark (curx+1, cury)
 PUSH (curx+1, cury) on stack.
 - E. If slot to the **NORTH** is open & is undiscovered
 Mark (curx, cury-1) as "discovered"
 PUSH (curx, cury-1) on stack.
 - F. If slot to the **SOUTH** is open & is undiscovered
 → Mark (curx, cury+1) as "discovered"
 → PUSH (curx, cury+1) on stack.
4. If the stack is empty and we haven't reached our goal position, then the maze is unsolvable.

cur = 3,1

3	2
4	1

Solving a Maze with a Stack

Depth-first Search Visualization



Watch how our search goes "deep" in the same direction until it hits a dead end...

It does this because it always processes the last item pushed on the stack...

Which happens to be right next to the current square being processed.

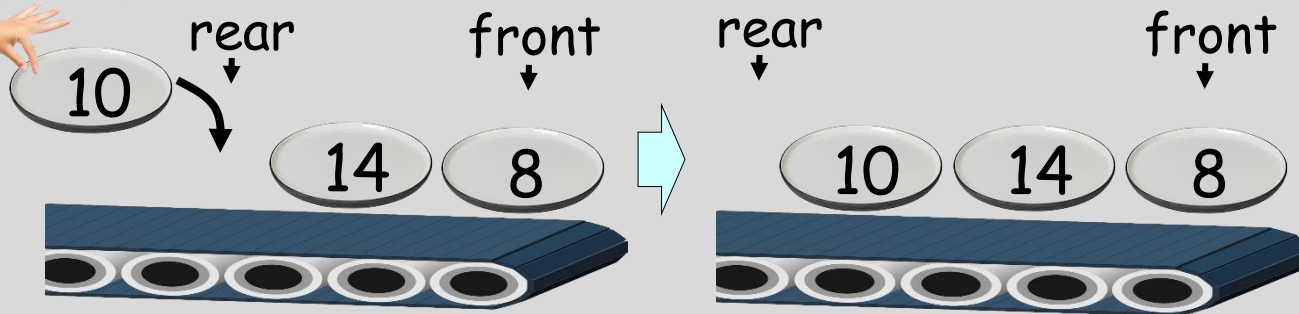
This is why it's called a "depth-first" search.

Queues

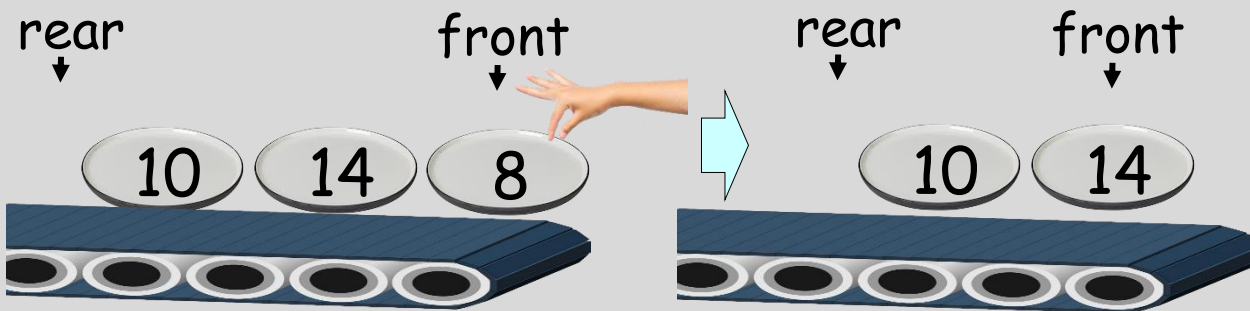
What's the big picture?

A queue is a super-useful* data structure that resembles a conveyer belt of dishes.

Dishes are added to the rear of the queue...



and dishes are extracted from its front...



The first-in/first-out property of queues is opposite of the last-in-first-out property of stacks.

Uses:

Use queues for vehicle navigation, implementing twitter feeds, queueing songs on Spotify, etc.

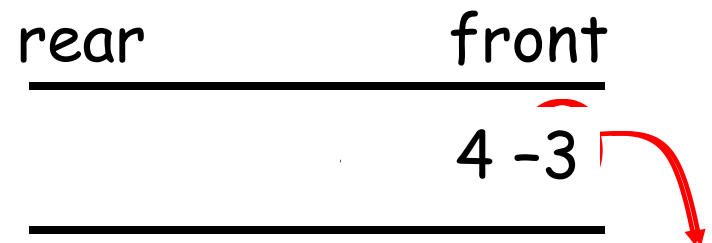
Another ADT: The Queue

The queue is another ADT that is just a like a *line* at the store or at the bank.

The first person in line is the first person out of line and served.

This is called a FIFO data structure:
FIRST IN, FIRST OUT.

Every queue has a *front* and a *rear*. You *enqueue* items at the *rear* and *dequeue* from the *front*.



What data structures could you use to implement a queue?

The Queue Interface

void enqueue(int a):

Inserts an item on the rear of the queue

int dequeue():

Removes and returns the top item from the front of the queue

bool isEmpty():

Determines if the queue is empty

int size():

Determines the # of items in the queue

int getFront():

Gives the value of the top item on the queue without removing it like dequeue

Like a Stack, we can have queues of any type of data! Queues of **strings**, **Points**, **Nerds**, **ints**, etc!

Common Uses for Queues

Often, data flows from the Internet faster than the computer can use it. We use a queue to hold the data until the browser is ready to display it...

Every time your computer receives a character, it enqueues it:

```
internetQueue.enqueue(c) ;
```

Every time your Internet browser is ready to get and display new data, it looks in the queue:

```
while (internetQueue.isEmpty() == false)
{
    char ch = internetQueue.dequeue() ;

    cout << ch;  // display web page...
}
```

Common Uses for Queues

You can also use queues to search through **mazes**!

If you **use a queue instead of a stack** in our searching algorithm, it will search the maze in a different order...

Instead of **always exploring the last x,y location** pushed on top of the stack first...

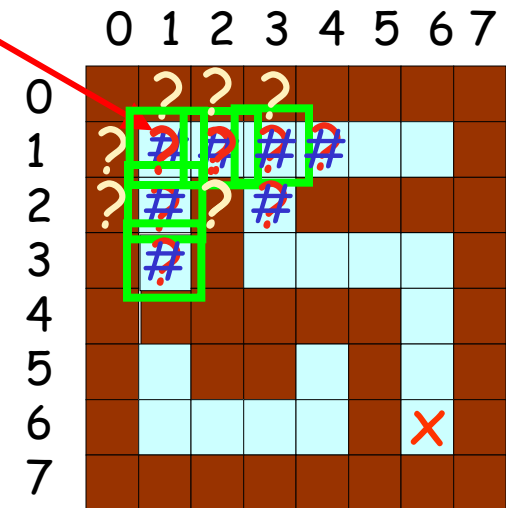
The new algorithm **explores the oldest x,y location** inserted into the queue first.

Solving a Maze with a Queue!

(AKA Breadth-first Search)

$sx, sy = 1, 1$

- 1. Insert **starting point** onto the queue.
- 2. Mark the **starting point** as "discovered."
- 3. While the queue is not empty:
 - A. ~~Remove the current cell from the maze queue.~~
 - B. ~~If we reached the end point, DONE! Otherwise...~~
 - C. If slot to the **WEST** is open & is undiscovered
Mark (curx-1,cury) as "discovered"
INSERT (curx-1,cury) on queue.
 - D. If slot to the **EAST** is open & is undiscovered
 - Mark (curx+1,cury) as "discovered"
 - INSERT (curx+1,cury) on queue.
 - E. If slot to the **NORTH** is open & is undiscovered
Mark (curx,cury-1) as "discovered"
INSERT (curx,cury-1) on queue.
 - F. If slot to the **SOUTH** is open & is undiscovered
 - Mark (curx,cury+1) as "discovered"
 - INSERT (curx,cury+1) on queue.
4. If the queue is empty and we haven't reached our goal position, then the maze is unsolvable.



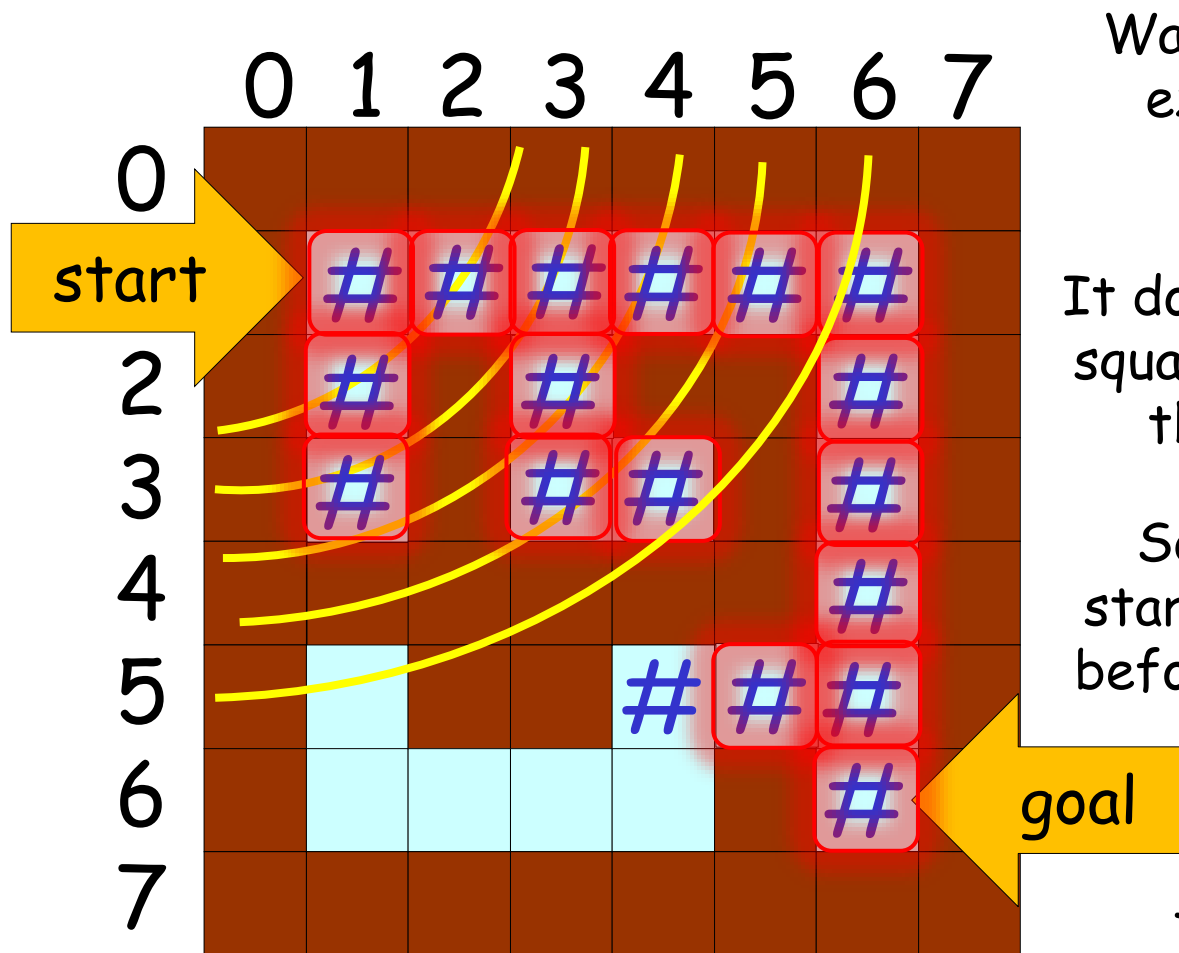
rear

front

			(3,2)	(3,2)	(2,1)
--	--	--	-------	-------	-------

Solving a Maze with a Queue

Breadth-first Search Visualization



Watch how the squares we explore expand out like ripples in a pond...

It does this because each new square to explore is added to the END of the queue...

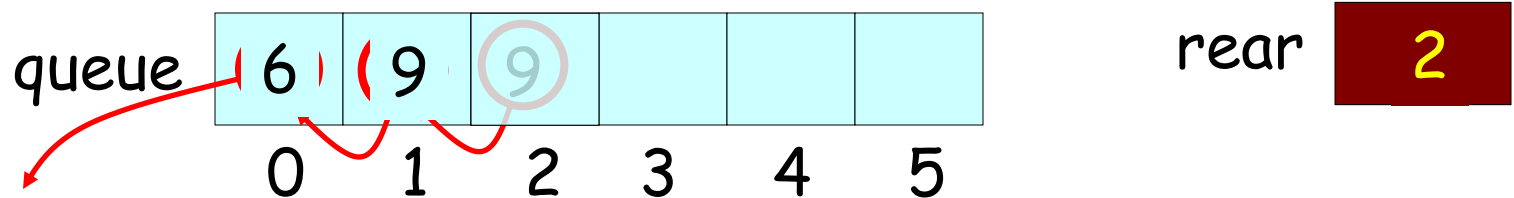
So squares closer to the starting square are explored before squares further away.

This is why it's called a "breadth-first" search.

Queue Implementations

We can use an **array** and an **integer** to represent a queue:

```
int queue[6], rear = 0;
```



- Every time you **insert** an item, place it in the rear slot of the array and increment the rear count
- Every time you **dequeue** an item, move all of the items forward in the array and decrement the rear count.

What's the problem with the array-based implementation?

If we have N items in the queue, what is the cost of:

(1) inserting a new item, (2) dequeuing an item

Queue Implementations

We can also use a **linked list** to represent a queue:

- Every time you **insert** an item, add a new node to the end of the linked list.
- Every time you **dequeue** an item, take it from the head of the linked list and then delete the head node.

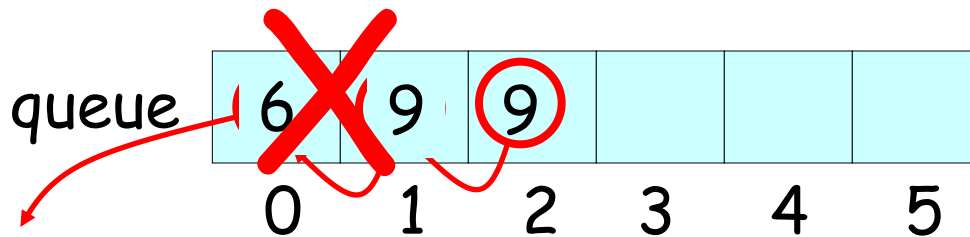
Of course, you'll want to make sure you have both **head** and **tail pointers**...

or your linked-list based queue will be really inefficient!

The Circular Queue

The circular queue is a clever type of **array-based** queue.

Unlike our previous array-based queue, we never need to **shift items** with the circular queue!



Let's see how it works!

A Queue in the STL!

The people who wrote the Standard Template Library also built a queue class for you:

```
#include <iostream>
#include <queue>

int main()
{
    std::queue<int> iqueue;    // queue of ints

    iqueue.push(10);          // add item to rear
    iqueue.push(20);
    cout << iqueue.front();    // view front item
    iqueue.pop();             // discard front item
    if (iqueue.empty() == false)
        cout << iqueue.size();
}
```